

Aaron I. Pollock

Software Engineer • Backend Systems, APIs & Production Debugging

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Summary

Software engineer with a backend focus on APIs, integrations, and production systems. Experienced in building and maintaining RESTful services, with a strong emphasis on understanding system behavior in real-world conditions.

Skilled at debugging complex API issues, tracing requests across services, and resolving failures across authentication, data, and third-party integrations. Known for translating technical problems into clear, actionable insights for both engineers and stakeholders.

Technical Skills

API & Debugging: REST APIs, Postman, request tracing, log analysis • **Languages:** JavaScript, Python, SQL • **Backend:** Node.js, Express • **Databases:** MongoDB, PostgreSQL • **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (S3, EC2, IAM, Cloud Practitioner certification), Docker • **Tools:** Git/GitHub, Postman, Sentry, Pino, Jira • **Frontend:** React, React Native

Experience

Better Angels LA — Volunteer Engineering Team Member

Los Angeles, CA | Oct 2024 – Present

- Debugged backend services in a Django REST Framework + GraphQL monorepo supporting production workflows
- Traced API and data-flow issues using logs and request inspection to identify root causes and restore expected behavior
- Supported REST endpoints powering mobile features and third-party integrations
- Documented recurring issues and resolution patterns to improve team troubleshooting speed

Low-sAI — www.low-sai.com (Live App)

Node.js | Express | MongoDB | Jan 2025 – Present

- Built and maintained a full-stack app with 10+ REST endpoints for authenticated user flows and third-party integrations
- Engineered JWT authentication and optimized MongoDB schemas with pagination for performance and payload efficiency
- Introduced structured logging (Pino) with request correlation to improve observability and debugging efficiency
- Integrated Sentry for error tracking and performance monitoring, enabling faster incident triage
- Diagnosed and resolved API request failures across authentication, external AI services, and data retrieval using request tracing
- Centralized error handling to standardize responses and prevent exposure of sensitive stack traces

Selected Projects

Note2be — capstone-project-xsl6.onrender.com

- Designed normalized PostgreSQL schemas using SQLAlchemy ORM
- Implemented REST APIs supporting CRUD operations across relational models
- Resolved data consistency and API response issues across note, tag, and media workflows

Getsy — etsyclone-4ah1.onrender.com

- Developed backend services supporting e-commerce workflows and user interactions
- Configured AWS S3 for secure media uploads with controlled object access
- Investigated and resolved state and integration issues across cart, order, and media systems

Additional Experience

Elite Prep — Tutor & Curriculum Manager

Arcadia, CA | Jun 2010 – Aug 2023

- Delivered 1,000+ hours of instruction and built data-driven learning programs adopted across branches
- Created internal tools to track performance and automate reporting workflows
- Translated complex technical concepts into clear, structured explanations for students and staff

Education

App Academy — Full-Stack Web Development

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

University of Southern California — Cinematic Writing, BFA (Philosophy minor)

Aug 2000 – May 2004